- On receipt of a valid groupcast message, the associated fabric is the one identified by the Fabric Index stored in the Groupcast Session Context.

If the interaction is not associated with a fabric, the accessing fabric does not exist. In this case any comparison of the accessing fabric to any existing fabric SHALL consider them not equal.

7.5.2. Fabric-Index

Each fabric supported on a node is referenced by fabric-index that is unique on the node. This fabric-index enables the look-up of the full fabric information from the fabric-index. A fabric-index of 0 (zero) or NULL SHALL indicate that there is no fabric associated with the context in which the fabric-index is being used. If fabric-index is used in a context that is exclusively associated with a fabric, such as fabric-scoped data model elements, then the fabric-index values SHALL NOT include 0 (zero) or NULL.

The fabric-index corresponding to the accessing fabric is called the "accessing fabric-index". If the accessing fabric does not exist, the accessing fabric-index SHALL indicate no fabric with a fabric-index of 0.

7.5.3. Fabric-Scoped Data

Most cluster data instances are accessible regardless of the accessing fabric. However, data that is exclusively associated with a particular fabric SHALL be defined as being fabric-scoped. Fabric-scoped data SHALL be defined with fabric-scoped access.

The fabric associated with fabric-scoped data is called the "associated fabric".

Fabric-scoped data allows multiple accessing fabrics to manipulate a list of data items without interfering with each other. See Section 7.19.1.8.2, “Fabric-Filtered List”.

Fabric-scoped data SHALL be limited to the following:

- list of fabric-scoped structs, which MAY include fabric-sensitive fields
- fabric-sensitive event

A fabric-scoped data instance is always a composite struct-like data instance, with multiple fields.

Fabric-scoped data SHALL always include the FabricIndex field to indicate the associated fabric. The FabricIndex field for fabric-scoped data SHALL NOT be 0 or NULL.

Any interaction, including cluster commands, SHALL NOT cause modification of fabric-scoped data, directly or indirectly, if the interaction has an accessing fabric different than the associated fabric for the data, except in the case of a cluster command that explicitly defines an exception to this rule.

Data fields in a fabric-scoped struct MAY also have the fabric-sensitive access modifier.

7.5.4. Fabric-Scoped IDs

Some data types are fabric-scoped IDs, including, but not limited to, node ID and group ID.